

Whether you're shooting a full fledged short film or a random video for YouTube, don't let the colours go all over the place. Especially your blacks and whites. Also, ensure that your whites aren't bleached and every single video track has a broadcast safe filter slapped on.



Keep your colours in check.

Back-up

When you start editing, make sure you have a copy of all your footage stored somewhere. Preferably in tapes and definitely not in the computer you're editing on. The last thing you want is for your computer to crash and burn turning all the hard work done by the production crew in to a smouldering pile of ash and melted plastic.

Capture in low res

A good practice you can observe, especially while working with really heavy footage on a low spec machine is capturing all your footage in low res first and finishing your edit. This way, you won't waste too much time waiting for your clips and transitions to render and when you're ready to export the final file, all you need to do is replace all your media with the hi-res copies and reconnect media.

B-Roll

If you have access to B-Roll footage, don't be lazy and take a look. You may never know how that stuff might save you. Who knows, it just might save the day by giving you better quality audio.

Don'ts

Use tiny font

What a lot of editors do, especially the ones who don't have access to a standalone preview monitor is overcompensate and make the fonts too small. Needless to say, that's not good. Since we're on the subject of fonts, it would make more sense to use sans serif fonts instead of serifs. They're easier to read from a distance and on small screens.